WORK INTEGRATED LEARNING-20260821_095605-Meeting Recording

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35m 33s

Mlambo Msawakhe started transcription

RP

Rene Pietersen 2:41

Good morning, Benny.

BH

BENNY HLUNGWANE 2:42

Good morning, sir. How are you?

RP

Rene Pietersen 2:45

Benny, in all honesty, not well, but yeah, like I said earlier, I just wanted to honor the meeting request. Yeah.

BH

BENNY HLUNGWANE 2:53

Okay, no, I'm glad. Today I'm not alone. I'm with my group here.

RP

Rene Pietersen 3:00

Good day, everybody.

BL

Bokamoso Luvhengo 3:04

The day there.

UH

Unarine Hangwani 3:04

Good day, sir.

MM

Mlambo Msawakhe 3:05

Is it?

BH

BENNY HLUNGWANE 3:07

And they have some few questions for you and we are hoping that you also have

some questions for us. So I'm going to hand it over to Bruntley.
Sure.

Mothudi Bontle 3:26
Good day, sir. Thank you so much for your time. I have a few questions that I'm going to ask you and I'll open questions from you to ask after I'm done with every question that I want to ask. So the first thing that we want to know from you is What does your company do and what is its main responsibilities?

Rene Pietersen 3:50
Okay, GROUP, can we do it a little bit differently now? I don't mean to interject, but let's do this. Let me give a formal introduction of what we are currently doing, what the organization is currently doing, and then from there we can take it further. And then I can also explain where Date Machaka came in and what
It is that he wanted me to assist you guys with.

Mothudi Bontle 4:14
Okay, no problem.

Rene Pietersen 4:16
All right. Firstly, my name is Renee Peterson. I work for Mangwane Metropolitan Municipality. I am currently the Manager, Capacity Building and Stakeholder Management under the Directorate, Planning, Economic Development and Economic and Rural Development.
and human settlement. No, it's a bunch of directorates that have been grouped together under one, currently under one directorate. There is a future planning to maybe move human settlement away from that.
I currently fall under the sub-directorate implementation support, which is where Ndate Machaka then came to me to state that I must just see if I can assist you guys if there is any need for any additional programs that we need or some things that we...
might need to look at developing internal systems. Okay, now human settlement is a very broad, it's a very broad thing. RDP housing is one of the things that people know. The other thing is, sorry, just to say, I'm currently at home.
and I'm working from my headset. So if it drops, the wire in my headset sometimes

gives issues. So if it drops, just somebody tell me or just put it in the chat. So human settlement is a very broad thing and it goes all the way from what is what was previously known as RTP.
RDP housing to informal settlements, to land development, to distribution, to site allocation. It is a very broad field. It includes social housing. Currently, we have got 18 programs under human settlement. Obviously, like I stated previously, the one that is best known is RDP housing.
Okay, now, the program that Ntate Machaka wanted us to look at is specifically PTOs. So that is what is called permission to occupy. So what happens is, I think you might be aware of the situation that has happened in Lurir Park.
where people started to take over a piece of land, which is then known as an informal settlement. So they take over this informal settlement in a process to try and formalize it. Now, part of the formalization of this process is to say, all right, we're going to pin out sites.
And then we're going to hand over what is known as a PTO, a permission to occupy. This permission to occupy gives a person the right to be on that site for a period of six months while the site is not formalized. So in this case, there's not been a formalization of the, let's say, of the township.
OK, or of the neighborhood, so it's not formalized yet, so it's not on the auditor, not on the auditor, on the...
Land Master General's Survey. So it's not a formal site. Then what happens is you have got a PTO, so you've got a permission to occupy the site while the formalization of the site is then being done. Once the formalization of the site of the of the bigger site is done, or the neighborhood, let's call it the neighborhood, of the neighborhood is then done. Then you get handed over a title deed for your site. So that is, in short, what is known as the formalization of a township. So
The thing is, there's no, there's a couple of systems that we have in place.
So right now, from the National Department of Human Settlement, we have what is known as the National Housing Needs Register. This is a centralized database that is situated in Pretoria that is available for all nine provinces and all of the municipalities. to use to be able to capture people with specifically what it says for a needs register. So when people need housing, they get to register on there. Should there then be a project in a specific ward, the thing is to go to the needs register first. Then there's also another system
which is also nationally based, which is called the HSS Online, which is the housing

subsidy system, but it's an online module. So obviously, as I stated before, all of the municipalities and all of provincial government and local government can use that system. So that is where you would find people that have qualified for all of the various types of subsidies.
Under the various programs for each and every municipality.
So that would be my intro. I hope that that gives you a little bit of clarity as to where it is that our sub-director falls. I also have to state that the informal settlement unit under which the PTO program falls does not fall under
my auspices. It does fall under a different general manager in the form of Mtshabe, but I would I would have wanted us to have this meeting first because normally she would she would prefer that I have these meetings separately come to her with a formal
request to go forward and then to see what it is that we can do to assist her with all of her different programs. I would then stop there for now.

MB **Mothudi Bontle** 10:03
Okay, thank you so, so much. The information that you gave me answered a lot of questions that I had for you. So I want to know, since you guys already have a system, you guys already have systems that capture information about the housing and everything,
What is your current problem with the system? Like, what is it that you want us to do to improve the systems that you guys have?

RP **Rene Pietersen** 10:34
Okay, as I stated before, what we would look at is a system that could assist with specifically the handing outs and the control, let's say the control, monitoring, evaluation of permissions to occupy. So if we could get
A online version of a system that, let's let's for the for the for the for the purposes of the meeting, let's handle the Laurier Park as a situation. OK. I unfortunately was not directly involved there, so I would speak to the other people to say, all right, let's say there's 800 people.

MB **Mothudi Bontle** 11:06
FOR.

Rene Pietersen 11:14

that came on site. So these 800 people must now get a permission to occupy in this informal settlement known as Lurir Park Informal Settlement. So now those 800 people should then be monitored. They need to be captured. They need to be said, maybe send an SMS or an
e-mail after a six months, because I said PTOs are valid for six months. So what we would need in this situation is to say, right, for this section, the system would say, right, who are the 800 people, right? Capture the valid information for the 800 people. And then that system can then be used
on a monthly basis to say, all right, are the people still these 800 people? Is it possible to say, all right, can we verify per SMS? Can we verify per, SMS would most probably be the best way. So where you would have your interactive SMSs to say, all right, according to our knowledge,
you are site one of Lurir Park One or Lurir Park informal settlement, right? And then obviously after six months, say, all right, after five months, say, all right, you have been the recipient of PTO site number one for Lurir Park informal settlement.
you are then notified that within the next month, you need to come to the office and get your new PTO for the next six months. Otherwise, we can hand that site over to somebody else.

Mothudi Bontle 12:49

Okay, thank you so much. I think that is all. You've answered everything and you were so clear about what you want from us. I don't know if any of my group members have additional questions that they want to ask from you regarding everything that you have said. Do you guys have anything to say?
Want to ask?
PS Onalenna.

Unarine Hangwani 13:21

Good day, sir. I have a question. So what are the requirements that the individuals would have in order to qualify or obtain a PTO?

Rene Pietersen 13:31

Okay, in order for you to be eligible for a PT, obviously, okay, let me explain to you

what happens in real life. People go on site and they, well, what is known as squat. They go and they squat on this site. Now, that person that is squatting on this site obviously has to be, firstly, for you to be able to qualify for any of these subsidies, You have to be one of two things. You have to either be a South African citizen or you have to be what is called naturalized. So it is you are a foreigner that has applied for a South African ID and then you are naturalized. So that's obviously the first requirements. So that's the general detailed information with relation to who the person is.
you know, the general information with relation to that. Then there is the information with relation to the site. So where is the site located, geolocation, as well as the size of the site and what is currently on the site and what is the future progress going to be on the site. So with relation
to what information would be captured or initially captured, it would be basically three different things. It would be the individual's information, all of the detailed information with relation to the individual. Then secondly, it would be all of the site information, specifically the site. And then thirdly, it would be the location of where the
township or where the new informal settlement would be. So that is basically the crux of the middle of the information that we need. If these persons have dependents, that information also needs to be captured. So what people normally don't understand
is that for you to qualify for a RTP subsidy, and I'm sorry that I'm going to refer to it as an RTP subsidy, it's just an easier way for me to explain it because that's normally the way that people normally externally is used to the subsidy being called. For a person to be able to qualify for an RTP subsidy, you need to have
You need to be a South African citizen. You need to have financial dependence, whether they are minor or whether they are pensioners, but they have to be financially dependent on you. And you also need to be, so there is a criteria list. What I'll do is I'll get all of the criteria list, the requirements and all of those things in a document.
which I will then send to you guys next week. After this meeting, I will have a meeting next week with Meta Khedi, who is the general manager for informal settlement, so that I can explain to her what this process is that we are embarking on. And as I stated, I'm part of the stakeholder management informal implementation support group.

So then we would see from her side if she can give the go ahead for this program to run. But that's basically the crux of the information that we would require. So it would be those general fields with relation to where the person is named, surname, identification, male, female,
ID number, site allocation, dependents, if they have dependents, what are the dependents and things like that. I hope that answers your question with relation to the detailed with relation to the individual or the site.

Unarine Hangwani 16:50
Yes, sir, thank you.

Mlambo Msawakhe 17:00
Okay, good, good, good to say. This is Msawakhe. I have one question in regards to the department as a whole, including the current systems that you have. Like, what is the...
An issue that we are facing as a department, let's say you are working, you are working on a system, and you see that, no man, this process is taking a lot of time for me to complete or to do. Let me make it easy: if you have a metric pattern or a pattern that you have on a system that could do one part of your job instantly.
Why would that batching do?

Rene Pietersen 17:43
Thank you. Unfortunately, there's not going to be a magic button because the magic button needs to do a site allocation. It needs to get a beneficiary. It needs to get a beneficiary approved. It needs to have a title deed registered. It needs to then take that title deed and put it on the National Housing Database. It needs to get the contract
get a contractor on site, get the building plan approved, get the house built and get it then handed over to the beneficiary. So the current problem that we are having is with relation to specifically PTOs, there is no current system for PTO management. So what is happening is
they put things on Excel spreadsheets and they capture things like that. So that leaves it open for manipulation. So that's why, like I said, that's why Ndate Machaka came to me to say that I must see if we can do this with relation to PTO. There is a lot of...

Although there's a lot of processes, there's not a lot of systems. Yes, we have internal systems, but there's a lot of things that are still being done manually because of the fact that government does not always have the funds or the internal capacity to do all of these processes itself. And that's the thing.
So the magic button, if the magic button with relation to this thing is just to get internal processes to work properly. It would not even be systems related. It would be more to get processes aligned and then get processes to be more effective and efficient.
I know it doesn't answer the thing with relation to the system, but if I wanted a magic button, that's what the magic button should have needed to do.

MM **Mlambo Msawakhe** 19:25
Okay, thank you, thank you, sir.

MB **Mothudi Bontle** 19:37
Um, thank you, sir. Okay, you can talk, sir.

RP **Rene Pietersen** 19:42
Yeah, I just want to find out, if you guys were to develop, is it a systems development team that you guys are running? Because I see your guys are from IT. And if so, where would the system be housed and what would your requirements be for the system to be able to work?

MB **Mothudi Bontle** 20:06
Um...
Should I answer it or do you guys want to answer? I see I can see your hand is raised. Do you want to say something?

MA **Mnyamanzi Asive** 20:17
I was gonna ask a question.

MB **Mothudi Bontle** 20:19
Okay, okay, let me answer him quick. So, what we're offering, we're going to...
We are offering to develop a mobile app and a web application. So the mobile app, we're going to use Flutter for it because Flutter is versatile and it can be used with

Android or iOS, Linux, Mac OS. So we chose to do, we're choosing to develop a mobile app
using a Flutter framework or tool because it is versatile. It can be used through multiple devices like Android, iOS, Linux, etc. And then for the web application, we're going to use C#, ASP.NET Core.
And then for the information that you talked about, maybe the ID of a person or whatever, we're going to use Super Base for database. That information, we're going to store it in the Super Base database because we're considering costs that we don't have money.
to purchase a server that is going to store the database. So yeah, that is what we are offering. We are offering to develop an app or a mobile and a mobile application that will help solve your problem. And in this instance, it's the informal settlement. POT, six months permission, that whole thing that that is all for me. Yes, Asive you can ask.

MA **Mnyamanzi Asive** 21:55
I was going to ask, after the information has been kept at have been captured, how long should it be kept there in the system? And also, is there any confidential like details that we should not disclose?

RP **Rene Pietersen** 22:13
Yeah, according to Papaya, as you know, your basic information with relation to ID numbers and those type of things should not be disclosed. With relation to time frames, we would prefer this to be in the, let's call it PTO system. We would prefer this to be in the PTO system.
until such a time as the, I'm going to call it the neighborhood, the neighborhood is formalized and the informal, the neighborhood is formalized and housing needs have been addressed. Because what happens with the informal settlement is that it's an informal settlement. It needs to be formalized.
But if it's formalized, all that that means is that there are now sites and then the sites can be handed over. So the PTO process then goes over into a title deed process. So as soon as a title deed is registered for those people, it means that the site belongs to the person. So in this case, with relation to the PTO system,
that would be the end of that process. So, PTO, you can have your various statuses within the system, and we can discuss that with relation to what are the various

statuses that an individual within a site could have, and then
The end of that process obviously would be de-registered or de-handed over. So you could have three or four different internal statuses for a person, which would be dual, it would be the person and it would be the site.
Does it answer you?

Mnyamanzi Asive 23:55
Thank you so much, sir.

Rene Pietersen 23:57
All right. The other thing is, okay, what I'm going to do as well is, but this will only be maybe mid of next week. What I'm also going to do is I will then liaise with the Chief Technology Officer of Mangwane. Benny, I'm going to ask you just to ensure that I then get
the transcript because I see the meeting is being recorded and it's being transcribed. So I'm just going to request you after the meeting, download the transcript and then e-mail me the transcript so that I have the full transcript. Because the previous lady did answer me, but I don't know all of the databases and everything that you guys are doing. But what I would then do is
I would see if it's possible for us as Mhlanga Hoon to be able, after your project is done and everything, to might be able to migrate from your system over to our servers, or if it's possible for us to be able to create servers so that we can not lose the intellectual property that you guys are going to put into this, because
I understand that you want to cut on costs because of the fact that this is going to be mostly a free web project for you guys, because you cannot go over to SQL Server and things like that, because you do not have the funding for that. So, from that side, what I'm going to do is I'm also going to Leisa with another gentleman.
that used to be, he also liaises between, I don't know if you've ever heard of a gentleman by the name of Victor Bergman or Tulani Bergman, but he also has some, he used to work with a entity that was linked to CUT. I also liaise with him to see if we can then
link with either your principals or your lecturers to see how we can look at maybe possibly migrating the system after you've developed it. Because what you are saying, if you guys are talking about a web app and a Android app, it's very, very good for us to be able to have that because the municipality currently does not have

the front facing
Thing that that does that, and if you have that, and if it can then go back and communicate with the with the with the community, it will be awesome.

Mothudi Bontle 26:25
Okay, thank you so much, sir, for your time. But I have, I heard that you say you're going to get back to us by next week or what? We don't have time. You have to submit phase one by the end of this month. So I don't know how that is going to go.

Rene Pietersen 26:44
Okay, you're saying by the end of this month, which means by next week, Friday, you need to have all of the information in, at least for, so what I'll do is from my side, unfortunately, I need to liaise internally with other people. I'm not, I'm not the, I'm not the custodian of the program.

Mothudi Bontle 26:50
Yes, yes.

Rene Pietersen 27:04
That's the thing. I understand. And the reason why I've been contacted is because I get to liaise better with you guys, because I understand a little bit more with relation to the technology. But what I'll do is, unfortunately, our internal processes is I can't go ahead with the program.

Mothudi Bontle 27:18
Oh, okay.

Rene Pietersen 27:24
or with anything until I've liaised with a GM. Okay. So what I'm going to do is let me contact Ntate Machaka because he's at the level of a GM so that he can just liaise with Meta Kheri. I will then liaise with Ntate Mujanaka next week.

Mothudi Bontle 27:28
Thank you.

Rene Pietersen 27:45

so that I can get. So what I'll do is I'll give you, because I know what you guys need, you guys need the process, you guys need to find out what the documentation are, you guys need to know what is we have internally, all of those things. So I will basically format all of those information with relation to what we need with relation to the front end, what we lead with relation to the details of the individuals and things like that. So I liaise with my colleagues.

To to do those things, and then I will send you through the information by Wednesday.

Mothudi Bontle 28:15

OK, thank you so much. Thank you so much for your time, and yeah, we will be waiting to hear from you. Thank you. I think that is over, unless you have something else or something additional you want to say or ask, sir.

Rene Pietersen 28:22

All right.

Now, I just want to double check. So the freeware and everything that you guys are going to be, how are you going to host it? Are you going to use CUT resources for now? Or how are you going to host the program?

BENNY HLUNGWANE 28:45

We are going to use Super Base and we're going to have to subscribe. I think after three months we have to pay. So yeah, we're going to host it there and everything is going to be pushed on GitHub. So yeah, it's basically.

I wouldn't say CUT material, it's just something which is there online.

So, yeah, yeah.

Rene Pietersen 29:09

Superbase website.

BENNY HLUNGWANE 29:12

Yeah, it's for storing data.

Rene Pietersen 29:17
So it's a progress, basically an old progress SQL database.

BENNY HLUNGWANE 29:22
Yeah, yeah, yeah, it is.

Rene Pietersen 29:27
Okay, the thing is the reason why I'm asking is I'm just looking at
From your perspective, you guys are busy with a project. If we're going to handle it just as an academic project, that's fine. But now, from our perspective, we would like a development to follow through. And that's why I need to speak to the people internally. If
Bontle, if you understand what I mean with that, because now from your perspective, it's an academic process for you to be able to do that. From our perspective, it's just what can we get from the knowledge and how can we then sustain it? Because now internally, there are certain processes that we can't do. So externally, you guys want to do it as
cheaply as possible because you don't have the resources to be able to do it. But internally, it's going to be an internal process problem for us because we can't just go and get any freeware to use. So that's going to be the process. Otherwise, we're going to have to use to do this as an academic exercise.
not as a exercise to get a result at the end. Yes, you will get a result, but that will be a project that would not go further for the organization, if you guys understand me.

Mothudi Bontle 30:49
Yeah, I do understand.
We don't want, we don't want it only to be an academic project. We're doing the super base and everything because of the cost. It's not like we want it to be only the academic project. It can go beyond, but because of we don't have money, we don't have funding, that is why we're limited to certain
Like extend, that's why we use superbies because of the cost. Yeah, I don't know if I answered you.

Rene Pietersen 31:19

No, you did. I understand from the perspective that you are coming from as a student, but I also understand that the limitations that the organization have. Look, if it was a, if we were a private entity, we could just say, all right, fine, we take over the superbase account and we pay the superbase account.
I will then have to find out internally how we're going to do that process, because that is the information that I need from you guys. Because like I said, I now have to liaise with a bunch of internal stakeholders, the chief technology officer being one of the stakeholders that I have to engage in.
She has, and you guys have seen SCOPA now. I don't know if you guys are aware of SCOPA. You might be aware of the Mhlanga Commission, but there's a different other arm that they call SCOPA. That stands for the Special Committee on Public Accounts. Now note what it says. It says public accounts.
And that's the thing. So we have to make sure that we adhere to all of the internal processes so that we are not found wanting with relation to what it is that we had implemented.
So yes, at the end of the day, I would love a product that we can have to put forward, but let's see how we do this. I would like you guys, I would like to assist you guys to finish your project from the student capacity. And from the organization perspective, I would love us to have a product that we can use
But if that it cannot be, let it be. And I'm not being, I'm not being facetious or anything like that. There's internal processes that might happen. That's, you will see. A lot of people are frustrated with government. That's the problem a lot of the times with government internal processes.
take long. That's why they say there's a lot of red tape in government. Internal processes take long. And those processes could then hamper progress with relation to certain things. But let's see how far we get. Like I said, at the end of the day, you guys will have your project up and running.
If we need to take it over, we just need to see how we can take it over because your limitations currently now, which makes you go the freeware route, is restricting us from being able to take it over from freeware because we've got other regulations that say that we have
to do licensing in a certain way.
If, if that, if that, if that clarifies the the the the disjunction that we have there.

MB **Mothudi Bontle** 33:59

Yeah, thank you. It did clarify. I understand so.
I think we are done, unless there's someone that wants to say something.
If not, then we are done. Thank you so much, sir, for your time, and thank you everyone for participating in this meeting. We will hear from you, sir, before the end of next week. Thank you.

RP **Rene Pietersen** 34:32
Thank you guys. Have a good weekend and good luck with your studies.

MB **Mothudi Bontle** 34:37
Thank you.

MM **Mlambo Msawakhe** 34:38
If you think you're saying kid will soon, please.

RP **Rene Pietersen** 34:40
Thank you.

BH **BENNY HLUNGWANE** 34:41
Thanks, bye.

RP **Rene Pietersen** 34:43
Thanks, Benny. Just send me that transcript so that I can get on it, Benny.

BH **BENNY HLUNGWANE** 34:47
Alright, I'm gonna do so.

RP **Rene Pietersen** 34:48
All right, thank you.

BH **BENNY HLUNGWANE** 34:50
Sure.

RP **Rene Pietersen** 34:50
Thanks, bye.



Mlambo Msawakhe stopped transcription